

Competitive Spirit: How a Local Sporting Goods Store Competes with Big Chains

Gregory's Sporting Goods is located in the heart of Oklahoma and is a staple in the Baseball and Softball community across the state.

As competition from larger chains continues to grow, the family-owned store is working to maintain its reputation for great customer service and a wide variety of equipment at affordable prices.

Established in 1981, Gregory's has been a longtime staple in the Oklahoma Metro, even after moving from Del City to Moore and dealing with the rise of other large chains like Academy and Dick's.

One of the recent challenges for Gregory's is how suppliers' prices continue to grow. Bat and glove prices are up to around \$500 for the high-end equipment, and even simple things like helmets and socks are having their prices raised due to the recent tariffs.

Owner Gregory Moore is frustrated with the rising prices.

"Evoshield raised the price of their helmets from \$50 to \$80, and I am making sure we have the lowest prices in town. [Dick's](#) is selling theirs at \$80 so I sell them at \$70."

Gregory also spoke about how, in the coming months, they will have to increase the price of socks from \$5.99 to \$6.99, which is not a big change, but this small cause could have a big effect.

“Obviously for someone just buying a pair or two of socks the \$1 change won’t effect much, but for folks who run a team and buy them in bulk, I worry we will have a hard time selling them without having to offer a bulk discount.”

Along with having the lowest prices in town, Gregory’s values top-tier customer service. Manager Jarod Lucero, who handles screen-printing, glove relacing, and scheduling, cares about minimizing staff mistakes and does not hesitate to correct employees' errors.

“A lot of the people we hire here are local high school and college kids, so I have to give reminders that we have a standard to live up to.”

Along with supplying the best selection of baseball/softball equipment and apparel, one of the main driving factors of business at Gregory’s is the custom-made jerseys and hats, which are handled by Josh Moore.

Josh says that the uniforms department is the busiest part of business at Gregory’s, as he has hundreds of teams that he has helped make jerseys for, although whenever there is an error, Josh is always the first to take blame, and always works his hardest to fix it.

“Whenever we make a mistake on some jerseys, I probably feel worse about it than anyone,” Josh said, “I put so much time into my job, multiple nights a week, I stay late to make sure I am caught up on my work.”

Gregory’s has created a culture to care about their customers, as seen through Greg’s dedication to keeping prices low, Josh’s dedication to staying on schedule with the jerseys, and Jarod’s commitment to keeping the staff in check, but Collin Moore, a floor manager, makes sure everyone that walks through the door is taken care of, and makes sure the employees do the same.

“I try to help everyone that comes in here. It may be company policy to ask everyone if they need help, but I like helping and making their shopping trip much easier.”

Collin also makes sure the customers know what they are looking for when it comes to buying bats/gloves.

“I used to play baseball, so I know a lot,” Collin says, “many people who are just beginning their journey in baseball and softball have no idea what they are looking for when it comes to equipment, so I try to work with people and find them stuff within their price range.”

As prices continue to rise, Gregory’s will have to balance keeping costs low with maintaining the customer service that has kept the store in business for more than 40 years.

Sources:

Premier Sporting Goods: Gregory's Sporting Goods. Premier Sporting Goods | Gregory's Sporting Goods. (n.d.). <https://www.gregoryssportinggoods.com/>

EvoShield XVT 2.0 matte softball batting helmet | Dick's sporting goods. (n.d.).
<https://www.dickssportinggoods.com/p/evoshield-xvt-2-0-matte-softball-batting-helmet-23evsaxvt20mtthlmbtha/23evsaxvt20mtthlmbtha>

XVT 2.0 matte batting helmet with facemask | EvoShield. (n.d.-b).
<https://www.evoshield.com/en-us/product/xvt-2-0-helmet-matte-fm-wb57257>

Gregory Moore, (405) 672-4230

Josh Moore, (405) 740-5107, gregorys4421@yahoo.com

Jarod Lucero, (405) 535-5255

Collin Moore, (405) 778-1710